

RIP Connor Murphy

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 08, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MNr1IF2hMyk> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter reflects on the life and death of Connor Murphy — a fitness influencer he once managed — who died in Thailand at 32, tracing a cautionary arc from extraordinary success to a psychedelic-triggered mental health collapse.

Contents

- 🧤 Who Connor Murphy Was and Brandon's Relationship With Him
- 💰 Connor's Rapid Rise to Fame and Financial Success
- ⚠️ The Turning Point: Ayahuasca and Mental Health Collapse
- 🧠 Bipolar Disorder, Psychedelics, and the Science Behind the Risk
- 🎯 The Ayahuasca "Russian Roulette" Warning
- ❤️ Final Tribute and Call to Action

Who Connor Murphy Was and Brandon's Relationship With Him 0:01

- Connor Murphy was a fitness/lifestyle YouTuber who died in Thailand
 - Brandon explicitly says he does not want to detail the circumstances of the death, deferring to other channels
- Brandon and Connor were very close approximately **eight years ago**, less so in recent years
- Brandon first noticed Connor when he came onto the YouTube scene and immediately recognized his potential
 - "I saw, oh man, this dude is going to be a big deal"
- Connor was still a **senior in college** when they first connected
- Brandon was already running a substantial business and had experience managing influencers at that time
- Brandon approached Connor with a business partnership offer:
 - Brandon's team would build the entire business infrastructure
 - Connor's only job would be to make content
 - They would split revenue
 - Connor would not have to handle any business operations himself
- Brandon describes Connor physically: taller than Brandon (who is 6'2"), and in better shape, at least at that age



Connor's Rapid Rise to Fame and Financial Success 1:35

- Immediately after college, Connor began making **hundreds of thousands of dollars**
 - Revenue came from both YouTube ad revenue and business ventures managed by Brandon's team
- They launched multiple online courses, each of which "crushed it"
- They launched an **athletic clothing line** for Connor
 - Made **\$60,000 on the first day**
- A **supplement line** was also being planned before things fell apart
- Connor reached **2 million YouTube subscribers in approximately one year**
 - Brandon notes it took him 15 years to reach 1 million subscribers
- On a personal level, Connor had extraordinary social success everywhere they traveled
 - Brandon and his team did events across the United States and internationally: London, Australia, Toronto, and other cities
 - "Women would just throw themselves at him everywhere we went"
 - Brandon says he watched in shock: "I never seen nothing like this, man. You got it all."
- Summary of what Connor had: height, exceptional physique, millions in income, millions of followers, and extraordinary romantic attention — "he had everything"



The Turning Point: Ayahuasca and Mental Health Collapse 3:37

- Around the time of the pandemic, Connor uploaded a YouTube video stating he was going to **take his own life**
 - Brandon, his mother, and the whole team were deeply shaken by this
 - Connor was found approximately **two days later** and was hospitalized in a mental health facility
- The day before uploading that video, Connor had **experimented with Ayahuasca** (a powerful psychedelic)
 - Brandon calls this the origin of "the cautionary tale"
- After that experience, "he was never the same"
 - His erratic public behavior during the pandemic was real, not an act
- The medical community's assessment: Connor had **bipolar disorder**
 - Powerful psychedelics can induce or intensify **manic episodes** in people with bipolar disorder
- After the breakdown, Connor took his career in a different direction and they stopped working together, though remained on cordial terms
- Brandon spoke with Connor a year or two after the episode:
 - Connor did **not remember** some of the things he had done during the manic period
 - Connor expressed embarrassment about his behavior
- Connor eventually went to Thailand, and his content seemed more grounded — "it seemed like he had his wits about him"

- However, Brandon says he could still recognize bipolar episodes when he saw them in the content
- Brandon believes what happened to Connor in Thailand leading to his death **looks like a manic episode**, though he stresses he is not qualified to diagnose

Bipolar Disorder, Psychedelics, and the Science Behind the Risk 5:59

- Brandon himself has **bipolar type 2** (a milder form) and did not learn this until his 30s
 - He knew something was different about him but lacked a diagnosis for years
- Bipolar disorder often activates in the mid-20s — Connor was approximately **24** when the episode hit
 - Brandon compares this to the X-Men metaphor: "You got the mutant gene, but it don't kick in until a certain time"
- Connor died at **age 32**
- Research indicates Ayahuasca and similar powerful psychedelics can:
 - **Expedite** the onset of bipolar disorder
 - **Intensify** the severity of episodes
 - Permanently alter brain chemistry — "you are a different person after this"
- Brandon notes that people with **undiagnosed mental health conditions** are at particular risk because they don't know they're vulnerable

The Ayahuasca "Russian Roulette" Warning 7:58

- Brandon's core statistic: approximately **6% of the population** will respond negatively to Ayahuasca and require professional help after a single use
- He contextualizes 6% against pharmaceutical drug approval standards:

Standard	Threshold	Consequence if Exceeded
Common side effects (e.g., nausea, diarrhea) for an approved drug	~1%	Drug would not be approved or sold in pharmacies
Severe psychiatric hospitalization risk for any approved medicine	0.1%	Drug would be illegal — not just unapproved
Ayahuasca: severe negative psychological response	~6%	Widely promoted in wellness circles anyway

- Brandon is furious at "yuppie hippie wellness" influencers and retreat promoters who advocate universally for Ayahuasca
 - "You played Russian roulette and you ended up on the right side of it. But not everybody's going to."
 - "Some people will never be the same. And some of those people were my friends."
- Emergency rooms and psychiatrists regularly see patients who had severe breakdowns following Ayahuasca retreats — Brandon calls this "not uncommon at all"

- He is careful not to place **100% blame** on Ayahuasca:
 - Acknowledges Connor had an underlying condition that was a major factor
 - Notes his own father also took his own life, suggesting he sympathizes with the complexity of mental illness

"This lawaska stuff is Russian roulette. And I don't want to blame it 100% on that — he obviously has some condition. But man, yo, mental health is important."

💔 Final Tribute and Call to Action 12:50

- Brandon extends the message to mental health broadly:
 - If you're feeling depressed or struggling: **see a therapist or psychiatrist**
 - "If you let this stuff just go, man, you could fuck up everything. You could fuck your whole life up. And it don't have to be like that."
- Brandon shares his own history:
 - Has been **sober from recreational drugs for over 11 years**
 - Has seen therapists over the years to manage his bipolar type 2
 - Saw a therapist after his father's suicide
 - "What I've encountered clearly cemented my allegiance to sobriety"
- His message on recreational drugs broadly: "You don't need that shit. You don't need them recreational drugs. Stay off that shit — even if you don't have any mental issues."
 - Especially warns against psychedelics: "You're playing Russian roulette with your mental health and your life."
- Closes with a direct tribute: "Rest in peace to the homie Connor."
- Final call to action for anyone struggling: "Get some help, man. Talk to the right people. There's people out here."
 - Points to therapy as a legitimate, effective resource he has personally used